To informality and beyond:
A gender analysis of informal labour and precarious working conditions.

Online Appendix: Tables and Figures

Table 1.2 – Descriptive statistics of dependent variables

Variable	Obs.	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max	No answer	Omitted
Being an informal worker	688,521	0.524	0.499	0	1	0	0
Being a subordinate without a contract	480,089	0.416	0.493	0	1	6,830	201,602
Being an unpaid worker	688,521	0.044	0.206	0	1	0	0
Being paid on a daily basis	487,110	0.172	0.377	0	1	162,236	0
Earning less than the minimum wage	688,521	0.015	0.123	0	1	0	0
Working more than 48 hours	683,108	0.275	0.446	0	1	5,413	0
Having more than one job	686,644	0.058	0.234	0	1	68	0
Working outside daytime hours	672,086	0.745	0.436	0	1	462	0
Reporting feelings of underemployment	688,521	0.070	0.255	0	1	0	0

Notes on Table 1.2:

- *Being an informal worker: In Mexico, labour informality is measured based on social security registration. Wage employees are classified as informal if their employer does not register them with the IMSS. The self-employed are considered formal only if they pay their own pension contributions and have access to medical coverage. Ultimately, INEGI includes a variable in the ENOE that indicates whether the individuals are considered formal or informal workers based on these criteria.*

- *Being a subordinate worker without a contract: This variable omits employers, the self-employed and unpaid workers, since these types of jobs do not involve contracts. INEGI includes this variable in the ENOE survey to analyse only those who are employed by someone else and to identify whether they have a contract or not.*

- *Being paid on a daily basis: Almost 25% of workers who reported having a job did not provide information on their payment frequency. These cases are kept as missing values in this variable.*

- *Earning less than the minimum wage: The ENOE survey includes a question that informs respondents of the current monthly minimum wage in Mexico and then asks whether they earn more or less than the minimum wage. Nevertheless, many individuals report earning less than the minimum wage, not because they are being underpaid, but because they worked fewer than the standard 48 hours. Estimating the probability of earning less than the minimum wage without considering hours worked would lead to misleading results. INEGI includes a variable identifying individuals who earn less than the minimum wage despite working more than 48 hours. This is the variable employed in the regression analysis.*

Table 1.3 – Descriptive statistics of variables capturing individual and household characteristics

Variable	Obs.	Mean	Std. dev.	Min.	Max.	Pct.
Individual characteristics						
Female	688,521	0.398	0.490	0	1	-
Age	688,521	39.220	14.281	12	98	-
Level of education						
0: No studies	19,465	-	-	-	-	2.83
1: Primary school	136,031	-	-	-	-	19.77
2: Secondary school	196,786	-	-	-	-	28.60
3: High school	145,138	-	-	-	-	21.10
4: Technical career	29,091	-	-	-	-	4.23
5: Graduate or postgraduate	161,482	-	-	-	-	23.47
Marital status						
1: Free union	118,659	-	-	-	-	17.24
2: Separated	32,480	-	-	-	-	4.72
3: Divorced	15,349	-	-	-	-	2.23
4: Widowed	18,282	-	-	-	-	2.66
5: Married	301,090	-	-	-	-	43.73
6: Single	202,616	-	-	-	-	29.43
Household characteristics						
Household in urban area	688,521	0.627	0.484	0	1	-
Kids in the household (6 years or less)						
No kids	485,913	-	-	-	-	70.57
1 kid	152,676	-	-	-	-	22.17
2 kids	41,804	-	-	-	-	6.07
3 kids	6,795	-	-	-	-	0.99
4 or more kids	1,333	-	-	-	-	0.19
Household socioeconomic strata						
1: Low	82,013	-	-	-	-	11.91
2: Medium-low	345,281	-	-	-	-	50.15
3: Medium-high	183,482	-	-	-	-	26.65
4: High	77,745	-	-	-	-	11.29
Household members						
1 household member	25,929	-	-	-	-	3.77
2 household members	85,753	-	-	-	-	12.45
3 household members	132,140	-	-	-	-	19.19
4 household members	171,909	-	-	-	-	24.97
5 household members	127,715	-	-	-	-	18.55
6 household members	68,481	-	-	-	-	9.95
7 household members	35,767	-	-	-	-	5.19
8 household members	18,686	-	-	-	-	2.71
9 household members	10,022	-	-	-	-	1.46
10 household members	5,495	-	-	-	-	0.80
11 or more	6,624	-	-	-	-	0.96

Table 1.4 – Descriptive statistics: year, quarter and Mexican states

Variable	Obs.	Mean	Std. dev.	Min.	Max.	Pct.
Year quarter						
2016, 1st quarter	167,881	-	-	-	-	24.38
2017, 2nd quarter	171,011	-	-	-	-	24.84
2018, 3rd quarter	170,516	-	-	-	-	24.77
2019, 4th quarter	179,113	-	-	-	-	26.01
State - Federal Entity						
Aguascalientes	19,997	-	-	-	-	2.90
Baja California	23,693	-	-	-	-	3.44
Baja California Sur	16,254	-	-	-	-	2.36
Campeche	19,958	-	-	-	-	2.90
Coahuila	27,097	-	-	-	-	3.94
Colima	19,879	-	-	-	-	2.89
Chiapas	22,487	-	-	-	-	3.27
Chihuahua	21,481	-	-	-	-	3.12
Mexico City	17,765	-	-	-	-	2.58
Durango	22,324	-	-	-	-	3.24
Guanajuato	29,738	-	-	-	-	4.32
Guerrero	20,078	-	-	-	-	2.92
Hidalgo	17,950	-	-	-	-	2.61
Jalisco	25,481	-	-	-	-	3.70
México	30,394	-	-	-	-	4.41
Michoacan	20,793	-	-	-	-	3.02
Morelos	17,608	-	-	-	-	2.56
Nayarit	21,252	-	-	-	-	3.09
Nuevo Leon	23,763	-	-	-	-	3.45
Oaxaca	23,847	-	-	-	-	3.46
Puebla	25,539	-	-	-	-	3.71
Queretaro	17,760	-	-	-	-	2.58
Quintana Roo	18,657	-	-	-	-	2.71
San Luis Potosi	20,750	-	-	-	-	3.01
Sinaloa	21,101	-	-	-	-	3.06
Sonora	19,580	-	-	-	-	2.84
Tabasco	19,094	-	-	-	-	2.77
Tamaulipas	21,439	-	-	-	-	3.11
Tlaxcala	20,525	-	-	-	-	2.98
Veracruz	20,292	-	-	-	-	2.95
Yucatan	21,382	-	-	-	-	3.11
Zacatecas	20,563	-	-	-	-	2.99

Table 1.5 – Descriptive statistics of the variable capturing 50 economic activities

Classification of economic activities	Obs.	Mean	Std. dev.	Min.	Max.	Pct.	Total workers (2019)	Informality Rate (2019)	Share of Women (2019)	Coefficient of variation
1 Agriculture	48,609	-	-	-	-	7.06	5,823,845	88.28	12.49	1.67
2 Animal breeding & exploitation	8,703	-	-	-	-	1.26	818,301	80.34	13.22	2.84
3 Aquaculture	226	-	-	-	-	0.03	20,613	47.36	24.57	11.85
4 Fishing	1,878	-	-	-	-	0.27	161,219	84.94	3.77	8.48
5 Mining	3,159	-	-	-	-	0.46	181,270	17.23	13.51	4.36
6 Supply of electricity, water or gas	2,867	-	-	-	-	0.42	200,342	10.06	18.81	3.33
7 Informal construction	46,979	-	-	-	-	6.82	3,599,306	85.83	2.63	1.01
8 Formal construction	9,484	-	-	-	-	1.38	632,296	32.81	9.42	1.86
9 Formal manufacturing	37,242	-	-	-	-	5.41	3,002,453	3.96	35.43	1.17
10 M: Food industry	22,854	-	-	-	-	3.32	2,098,743	56.20	44.91	1.45
11 M: Beverage and tobacco industry	3,658	-	-	-	-	0.53	274,305	34.38	21.57	3.19
12 M: Textile Inputs	1,487	-	-	-	-	0.22	144,766	35.71	37.33	6.64
13 M: Textile products, except clothing	3,187	-	-	-	-	0.46	272,220	81.56	75.63	5.19
14 M: Clothing manufacturing	8,866	-	-	-	-	1.29	713,414	61.19	66.80	3.09
15 M: Leather goods manufacturing	5,506	-	-	-	-	0.80	304,626	48.06	33.76	4.40
16 M: Wood industry	1,811	-	-	-	-	0.26	144,593	69.67	19.38	6.25
17 M: Paper industry	2,017	-	-	-	-	0.29	220,112	26.93	38.67	3.90
18 M: Printing and related industries	1,932	-	-	-	-	0.28	164,761	44.22	32.64	3.90
19 M: Non-metal mineral-based products	4,925	-	-	-	-	0.72	349,025	48.11	15.78	5.23
20 M: Metal products	9,043	-	-	-	-	1.31	700,658	46.39	10.79	1.75
21 M: Furniture, mattresses, and blinds	5,646	-	-	-	-	0.82	460,521	64.46	13.09	2.50
22 Wholesale trade	20,250	-	-	-	-	2.94	1,524,190	29.78	26.13	1.38
23 Transportation: Air/Water/Railway	29,568	-	-	-	-	4.29	2,509,717	57.81	9.09	1.08
24 Media services	5,356	-	-	-	-	0.78	399,741	13.61	34.27	2.54
25 Finance and insurance	6,630	-	-	-	-	0.96	574,165	15.05	51.67	2.15
26 Real estate	4,623	-	-	-	-	0.67	331,989	45.85	39.89	2.60
27 Technical/Professional/Scientific	17,542	-	-	-	-	2.55	1,442,714	32.35	41.24	1.51
28 Corporate services	754	-	-	-	-	0.11	59,563	3.86	49.99	6.02
29 Business support	19,751	-	-	-	-	2.87	1,497,958	32.71	35.66	1.29
30 Education services	38,810	-	-	-	-	5.64	2,684,125	17.18	62.76	1.04
31 Health and social assistance	24,146	-	-	-	-	3.51	1,648,510	24.83	67.70	1.25
32 Culture, sports, leisure	6,422	-	-	-	-	0.93	481,566	65.29	26.90	2.25
33 Government	36,461	-	-	-	-	5.30	2,387,417	18.66	40.61	1.07
34 Street trade & street services	19,885	-	-	-	-	2.89	1,740,168	97.96	55.11	1.53
35 Mexican grocery stores	33,006	-	-	-	-	4.79	2,974,073	76.70	60.37	1.05
36 Convenience and department stores	13,776	-	-	-	-	2.00	993,486	12.20	52.36	1.64
37 R: Clothing/footwear/etc	10,492	-	-	-	-	1.52	920,124	68.33	69.24	1.86
38 R: Health care products	4,415	-	-	-	-	0.64	389,510	39.85	63.91	2.73
39 R: Stationery & other items	7,808	-	-	-	-	1.13	636,664	66.03	67.17	2.15
40 R: Computers or household items	8,245	-	-	-	-	1.20	661,448	65.17	49.26	1.93
41 R: Hardware & glassware	5,407	-	-	-	-	0.79	433,846	45.33	34.58	2.51
42 R: Vehicles/autoparts/fuel	9,407	-	-	-	-	1.37	656,162	26.12	22.91	1.91
43 Internet & catalog-based retail	7,166	-	-	-	-	1.04	551,198	94.05	93.64	1.97
44 Hotels: Temporary accommodation	7,248	-	-	-	-	1.05	444,692	12.59	44.98	2.38
45 Restaurant/Bar: Food/drinks	44,655	-	-	-	-	6.49	3,491,055	73.35	60.07	0.96
46 Repair/maintain: Cars/trucks	14,105	-	-	-	-	2.05	996,729	71.17	3.70	1.47
47 Repair/maintain: Machines/appliances	8,278	-	-	-	-	1.20	651,601	64.76	23.40	1.82
48 Haircuts/Grooming/Makeup	6,563	-	-	-	-	0.95	539,148	78.77	82.92	2.10
49 Associations/Organizations	3,181	-	-	-	-	0.46	233,289	67.22	46.30	3.08
50 Domestic employees	30,365	-	-	-	-	4.41	2,421,327	96.74	90.04	1.07
51 Other activities	14,127	-	-	-	-	2.05	1,237,516	68.05	41.03	1.50
Total	688,521	-	-	-	-	100.00	55,801,080	-	-	-

Notes on Table 1.5:

- The descriptive statistics are based on the whole sample, which includes four different years.

- Informality rates and the share of women in each activity were estimated using the 2019 dataset exclusively.

- Economic activities starting with M refer to manufacturing activities.

- Economic activities starting with R refer to retail services.

- INEGI establishes reliability thresholds indicating the degree of statistical precision based on the coefficient of variation of the estimates.

- A coefficient of variation greater than 30% indicates low reliability, and it requires cautious interpretation, including an analysis of the causes of the high variability and the consideration of alternative precision measures such as confidence intervals (INEGI, 2021a).

- A threshold between 15% and 30% indicates moderate reliability (INEGI, 2021a).

- A coefficient of variation below 15% denotes high reliability (INEGI, 2021a).

- The coefficient of variation for all economic activities is below 15%, which implies that the estimates at this level of disaggregation are highly reliable.

- The estimation of the coefficient of variation for each economic activity explicitly incorporates ENOE's survey design, which considers the primary sampling units, sampling weights and stratification structure.

- The reported statistics appropriately reflect the underlying sample design rather than assuming simple random sampling.

- The ENOE survey is designed to be representative at the national level, across the 32 federal states, and between urban and rural areas of Mexico.

Table 1.6 - Descriptive statistics of the variable 'NAICS: Economic activities'

NAICS Subsector Code	NAICS Subsector Name	NAICS Activity Code	NAICS Activity Name	Obs.	Pct.	50 Economic Activities	Name of 50 Economic activities
1	Agriculture	1110	1110 Agriculture	48,625	7.1	1	Agriculture
1	Agriculture	1121	1121 Animal breeding and production	8,706	1.3	2	Animal breeding and exploitation
1	Agriculture	1122	1122 Aquaculture	226	0.0	3	Aquaculture
1	Agriculture	1130	1130 Forestry	607	0.1	51	Other economic activities
1	Agriculture	1141	1141 Fishing	1,910	0.3	4	Fishing
1	Agriculture	1142	1142 Hunting and trapping	12	0.0	51	Other economic activities
1	Agriculture	1150	1150 Services related to agricultural and forestry activities	486	0.1	51	Other economic activities
1	Agriculture	1199	1199 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 11	.	.	51	Other economic activities
2	Mining	2110	2110 Oil and gas extraction	700	0.1	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2121	2121 Coal mining	140	0.0	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2122	2122 Metallic mineral mining	1,144	0.2	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2123	2123 Non-metallic mineral mining	652	0.1	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2129	2129 Insufficiently specified descriptions of metallic and non-metallic minerals	8	0.0	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2131	2131 Mining-related services	168	0.0	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2132	2132 Drilling of oil and gas wells	345	0.1	5	Mining and oil
2	Mining	2199	2199 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 21	2	0.0	5	Mining and oil
3	Electricity, water, gas	2210	2210 Electricity generation, transmission and distribution	1,393	0.2	6	Electricity, water, gas
3	Electricity, water, gas	2221	2221 Water collection, treatment and supply	1,388	0.2	6	Electricity, water, gas
3	Electricity, water, gas	2222	2222 Gas supply through pipelines to the final consumer	86	0.0	6	Electricity, water, gas
4	Construction	2361	2361 Residential building construction	22,062	3.2	7	Informal construction
4	Construction	2362	2362 Self-built residential construction	.	.	51	Other economic activities
4	Construction	2363	2363 Non-residential building construction	2,079	0.3	8	Formal construction
4	Construction	2370	2370 Civil engineering works construction	4,460	0.7	8	Formal construction
4	Construction	2381	2381 Specialised construction work	2,927	0.4	8	Formal construction
4	Construction	2382	2382 Masonry, plumbing, electrical installations, and outdoor construction work	24,917	3.6	7	Informal construction
4	Construction	2399	2399 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 23	18	0.0	51	Other economic activities
5	Manufacturing	3110	3110 Food industry	23,004	3.3	10	M: Food industry
5	Manufacturing	3120	3120 Beverage and tobacco industry	3,674	0.5	11	M: Beverage and tobacco
5	Manufacturing	3130	3130 Manufacture of textile inputs and textile finishing	1,488	0.2	12	M: Textile Inputs
5	Manufacturing	3140	3140 Manufacture of textile products, except apparel	3,192	0.5	13	M: Textile products
5	Manufacturing	3150	3150 Manufacture of clothing and apparel	8,868	1.3	14	M: Clothing
5	Manufacturing	3160	3160 Manufacturing, tanning and finishing of leather, hide and substitute products	5,507	0.8	15	M: Leather goods manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3210	3210 Wood industry	1,815	0.3	16	M: Wood industry
5	Manufacturing	3220	3220 Paper industry	2,017	0.3	17	M: Paper industry
5	Manufacturing	3230	3230 Printing and related industries	1,933	0.3	18	M: Printing industry
5	Manufacturing	3240	3240 Manufacture of petroleum and coal products	619	0.1	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3250	3250 Chemical industry	3,015	0.4	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3260	3260 Plastic and rubber industry	4,860	0.7	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3270	3270 Manufacture of non-metallic mineral products	4,925	0.7	19	M: Non-metal mineral-based products
5	Manufacturing	3310	3310 Basic metal industries	1,483	0.2	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3320	3320 Manufacture of fabricated metal products	9,043	1.3	20	M: Metal products
5	Manufacturing	3330	3330 Manufacture of machinery and equipment	1,707	0.3	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3340	3340 Manufacture of computing and communication equipment, components, or accessories.	3,502	0.5	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3350	3350 Manufacture of electrical accessories, appliances, and power generation equipment	3,033	0.4	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3360	3360 Manufacture of transport equipment and motor vehicle parts	19,027	2.8	9	Formal manufacturing
5	Manufacturing	3370	3370 Manufacture of furniture, mattresses, and blinds	5,647	0.8	21	M: Furniture, mattresses, and blinds
5	Manufacturing	3380	3380 Other manufacturing industries	4,224	0.6	51	Other economic activities
5	Manufacturing	3399	3399 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 31–33	103	0.0	51	Other economic activities

NAICS Subsector Code	NAICS Subsector Name	NAICS Activity Code	NAICS Activity Name	Obs.	Pct.	50 Economic Activities	Name of 50 Economic activities
6	Wholesale trade	4310	4310 Wholesale trade of groceries, food, beverages, ice, and tobacco	8,279	1.2	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4320	4320 Wholesale trade of textile products and footwear	613	0.1	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4330	4330 Wholesale trade of pharmaceuticals, perfumes, small or big appliances	1,504	0.2	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4340	4340 Wholesale trade of agricultural and forestry raw materials, industrial supplies, and waste materials	7,386	1.1	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4350	4350 Wholesale trade of machinery, equipment, and furniture for agricultural, industrial, service, and commercial activities	2,065	0.3	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4360	4360 Wholesale trade of trucks, auto parts and accessories for cars, pickups and trucks	387	0.1	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4370	4370 Wholesale trade intermediation	122	0.0	22	Wholesale trade
6	Wholesale trade	4399	4399 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 43	24	0.0	22	Wholesale trade
7	Retail trade	4611	4611 Retail trade of groceries, food, beverages, ice, and tobacco	33,006	4.8	35	R: Mexican grocery stores
7	Retail trade	4612	4612 Street vending of groceries, food, beverages, ice, and tobacco	5,142	0.8	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4620	4620 Retail trade in self-service and department stores	13,779	2.0	36	R: Convenience and department stores
7	Retail trade	4631	4631 Retail trade of textile products, jewellery, fashion accessories, and footwear	10,492	1.5	37	R: Clothing/footwear/etc
7	Retail trade	4632	4632 Street vending of textile products, jewellery, fashion accessories, and footwear	2,492	0.4	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4641	4641 Retail trade of health care items	4,415	0.6	38	R: Health care products
7	Retail trade	4642	4642 Street vending of health care items	378	0.1	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4651	4651 Retail trade of stationery, recreational items, and other personal use articles	7,814	1.1	39	R: Stationery stores
7	Retail trade	4652	4652 Street vending of stationery, recreational items, and other personal use articles	1,505	0.2	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4661	4661 Retail trade of household appliances, computers, home decor items, and used goods	8,245	1.2	40	R: Computers or household items
7	Retail trade	4662	4662 Street vending of furniture, household goods, and used goods	2,955	0.4	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4671	4671 Retail trade of hardware, paint supplies, and glass	5,407	0.8	41	R: Hardware & glassware
7	Retail trade	4672	4672 Street vending of hardware and paint supplies	372	0.1	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4681	4681 Retail trade of motor vehicles, spare parts, fuels, and lubricants	9,407	1.4	42	R: Vehicles/autoparts/fuel
7	Retail trade	4682	4682 Street vending of automobile parts, accessories, and fuels	139	0.0	34	Street economy
7	Retail trade	4690	4690 Retail trade exclusively through the Internet, printed catalogues, and television	7,166	1.0	43	R: Internet & catalog-based retail
7	Retail trade	4699	4699 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 46	40	0.0	51	Other economic activities
8	Transport, mail, storage	4810	4810 Air transportation	313	0.1	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4820	4820 Rail transportation	206	0.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4830	4830 Water transportation	185	0.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4840	4840 Freight trucking	6,674	1.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4850	4850 Land passenger transportation, except rail	17,431	2.5	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4860	4860 Pipeline transportation	33	0.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4870	4870 Tourist transportation	528	0.1	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4881	4881 Transportation-related services	2,405	0.4	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4882	4882 Aircraft, ship, and train exterior cleaning and repair services	145	0.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4899	4899 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 48	.	.	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4910	4910 Postal services	230	0.0	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4920	4920 Courier and parcel delivery services	1,104	0.2	23	Transport, mail, storage
8	Transport, mail, storage	4930	4930 Storage services	316	0.1	23	Transport, mail, storage
9	Mass Media	5110	5110 Publishing of newspapers, magazines, books	961	0.1	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5120	5120 Film, video, and sound industry	714	0.1	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5150	5150 Radio and television	730	0.1	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5170	5170 Other telecommunications	2,757	0.4	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5180	5180 Electronic data processing, hosting, and other related services	37	0.0	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5190	5190 Other information services	192	0.0	24	Mass Media
9	Mass Media	5199	5199 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 51	2	0.0	24	Mass Media

NAICS Subsector Code	NAICS Subsector Name	NAICS Activity Code	NAICS Activity Name	Obs.	Pct.	50 Economic Activities	Name of 50 Economic activities
10	Finance and insurance	5210	5210 Central banking (Bank of Mexico)	3	0.0	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5221	5221 Commercial banking, and private sector fund and trust management	2,427	0.4	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5222	5222 Other non-stock market credit and financial intermediation institutions in the private sector	2,426	0.4	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5223	5223 Development banking, and public sector fund and trust management	125	0.0	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5229	5229 Insufficiently specified descriptions of non-stock market financial services	.	.	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5230	5230 Stock market, currency exchange, and financial investment activities	337	0.1	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5240	5240 Surety, insurance, and pension companies	1,311	0.2	25	Financial services
10	Finance and insurance	5299	5299 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 52	1	0.0	25	Financial services
11	Real estate	5310	5310 Real estate services	2,950	0.4	26	Real Estate
11	Real estate	5321	5321 Rental services of automobiles, trucks, and other land transportation	187	0.0	26	Real Estate
11	Real estate	5322	5322 Rental services and rental centres of movable goods, except land transportation equipment	1,477	0.2	26	Real Estate
11	Real estate	5330	5330 Rental services of trademarks, patents, and franchises	13	0.0	26	Real Estate
11	Real estate	5399	5399 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 53	.	.	26	Real Estate
12	Professionals, scientific, technical	5411	5411 Professional, scientific, and technical services	15,662	2.3	27	Professional services
12	Professionals, scientific, technical	5412	5412 Scientific research and development services	348	0.1	27	Professional services
12	Professionals, scientific, technical	5413	5413 Veterinary services	727	0.1	27	Professional services
12	Professionals, scientific, technical	5414	5414 Photography services	806	0.1	27	Professional services
13	Corporate services	5510	5510 Corporate offices	754	0.1	28	Corporate services
14	Business support	5611	5611 Business support services, employment services, secretarial support, and other business assistance services	5,813	0.8	29	Business support
14	Business support	5612	5612 Interior cleaning of airplanes, ships, and trains	12	0.0	29	Business support
14	Business support	5613	5613 Cleaning services, and installation and maintenance of green areas	5,157	0.8	29	Business support
14	Business support	5614	5614 Investigation, protection, and security services	5,817	0.8	29	Business support
14	Business support	5615	5615 Travel agencies and reservation services	741	0.1	29	Business support
14	Business support	5616	5616 Combined facility support services	214	0.0	29	Business support
14	Business support	5620	5620 Waste management and remediation services	1,999	0.3	29	Business support
15	Education	6111	6111 Private schools for basic, middle, and special education	6,124	0.9	30	Education
15	Education	6112	6112 Public schools for basic, middle, and special education	22,562	3.3	30	Education
15	Education	6119	6119 Unspecified sector (private/public) schools for basic, middle, and special education	2	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6121	6121 Private post-secondary non-university education institutions	25	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6122	6122 Public post-secondary non-university education institutions	118	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6129	6129 Post-secondary non-university education institutions	1	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6131	6131 Private higher education institutions	2,116	0.3	30	Education
15	Education	6132	6132 Public higher education institutions	5,790	0.8	30	Education
15	Education	6139	6139 Unspecified sector (private/public) higher education institutions	.	.	30	Education
15	Education	6141	6141 Other private educational services	1,793	0.3	30	Education
15	Education	6142	6142 Other public educational services	235	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6149	6149 Other unspecified sector (private/public) educational services	2	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6150	6150 Educational support services	50	0.0	30	Education
15	Education	6199	6199 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 61	.	.	30	Education

NAICS Subsector Code	NAICS Subsector Name	NAICS Activity Code	NAICS Activity Name	Obs.	Pct.	50 Economic Activities	Name of 50 Economic activities
16	Health and social assistance	6211	6211 Private outpatient medical and related services	6,311	0.9	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6212	6212 Public outpatient medical and related services	2,909	0.4	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6219	6219 Unspecified sector (private/public) outpatient medical and related services	.	.	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6221	6221 Private hospitals	2,000	0.3	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6222	6222 Public hospitals	10,250	1.5	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6229	6229 Unspecified sector (private/public) hospitals	1	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6231	6231 Private social and health care residential facilities	272	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6232	6232 Public social and health care residential facilities	150	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6239	6239 Unspecified sector (private/public) social and health care residential facilities	2	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6241	6241 Other private social assistance services	200	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6242	6242 Other public social assistance services	226	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6249	6249 Other unspecified sector (private/public) social assistance services	1	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6251	6251 Private childcare services	1,333	0.2	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6252	6252 Public childcare services	502	0.1	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6259	6259 Unspecified sector (private/public) childcare services	1	0.0	31	Health
16	Health and social assistance	6299	6299 Insufficiently specified descriptions of subsectors within Sector 62, Health and Social Assistance Services	2	0.0	31	Health
17	Recreational Entertainment	7111	7111 Artistic performance companies and groups	1,921	0.3	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7112	7112 Professional and semi-professional athletes and sports teams	303	0.0	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7113	7113 Promoters, agents, and representatives of artistic, sports, and similar events	199	0.0	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7114	7114 Independent artists, writers, and technicians	469	0.1	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7115	7115 Itinerant entertainment workers	13	0.0	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7120	7120 Museums, historical sites, zoos, and similar institutions	262	0.0	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7131	7131 Parks with recreational facilities and electronic game arcades	3,159	0.5	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7132	7132 National lottery ticket sales	139	0.0	32	Sports, culture, entrenainment
17	Recreational Entertainment	7133	7133 Street vending of national lottery tickets	18	0.0	34	Street economy
18	Hotels/Restaurants	7210	7210 Temporary accommodation services	7,316	1.1	44	Hotels
18	Hotels/Restaurants	7221	7221 Food and beverage preparation services	44,655	6.5	45	Restaurants
18	Hotels/Restaurants	7222	7222 Food and beverage preparation services by street vendors	6,078	0.9	34	Street economy
18	Hotels/Restaurants	7223	7223 Nightclubs	228	0.0	51	Other economic activities
19	Other Services	8111	8111 Automobile and truck repair and maintenance services	14,105	2.1	46	Repair/maintain: Cars/trucks
19	Other Services	8112	8112 Repair and maintenance of equipment, machinery, household, and personal items	8,279	1.2	47	Repair/maintain: Machines/appliances
19	Other Services	8119	8119 Insufficiently specified repair and maintenance services	9	0.0	51	Other economic activities
19	Other Services	8121	8121 Personal services	10,490	1.5	N/A	Further dissagregation using occupation codes
19	Other Services	8122	8122 Parking lots and garages for motor vehicles	403	0.1	51	Other economic activities
19	Other Services	8123	8123 Car care and washing services by street workers	373	0.1	34	Street economy
19	Other Services	8124	8124 Photo developing and printing services	15	0.0	51	Other economic activities
19	Other Services	8125	8125 Cemetery management services	60	0.0	51	Other economic activities
19	Other Services	8130	8130 Associations and organizations	3,181	0.5	49	Associations and Organizations
19	Other Services	8140	8140 Households with domestic workers	30,365	4.4	50	Domestic workers

NAICS Subsector Code	NAICS Subsector Name	NAICS Activity Code	NAICS Activity Name	Obs.	Pct.	50 Economic Activities	Name of 50 Economic activities
20	Government	9311	9311 Legislative bodies	366	0.1	33	Government
20	Government	9312	9312 Federal government administration	9,082	1.3	33	Government
20	Government	9313	9313 State government administration	16,007	2.3	33	Government
20	Government	9314	9314 Municipal government administration	10,993	1.6	33	Government
20	Government	9319	9319 Government administration with unspecified level	.	.	33	Government
20	Government	9320	9320 International and extraterritorial organisations	16	0.0	33	Government
20	Government	9399	9399 Insufficiently specified description of subsectors within sector 93, Government	3	0.0	33	Government
21	Unspecified	9700	9700 Support workers for shows and goods delivery workers	1,817	0.3	51	Other economic activities
21	Unspecified	9800	9800 Other workers in elementary and support activities	1,809	0.3	51	Other economic activities
21	Unspecified	9999	9999 Unspecified sector of activity	259	0.0	51	Other economic activities
			Total	688,521	100.0		

Notes on Table 1.6:

- *The economic activity 8121 'Personal services' required further disaggregation.*
- *Hairdressing, grooming, and make-up services accounted for 6,563 of the 10,490 observations in the economic activity 8121 'Personal services'.*
- *The remaining observations of economic activity 8121 were classified under category 51, 'Other Economic Activities'.*
- *Economic activity 4611 is associated with grocery stores that are commonly known in Mexico as 'corner stores' and are typically operated by the owner of the store.*
- *Economic activity 4620 refers to convenience stores such as 7-Eleven and Oxxo. In this case, the owners of the convenience stores hire employees to operate their business.*
- *Bachas et al. (2020) also makes a distinction between two types of stores in Mexico, the 'traditional' Mexican convenience store in the informal sector and the 'modern' convenience store in the formal sector, such as 7-Eleven or Oxxo.*
- *Economic activities starting with M indicate manufacturing activity.*
- *Economic activities starting with R indicate retail trade activity.*

Table 1.7 - Proportion of workers experiencing different precarious working conditions across 50 economic activities in Mexico

Sector	Informal employment rate	Working more than 48 hours per week	Employee without contract	Job paid on a daily basis	Working at night (8 pm-6 am)	Second job	Under employment	Minimum wage or less	Unpaid work	Total workers	Share of the labour force
Street trade & street services	98.0	24.1	97.9	52.8	84.1	5.4	14.8	3.9	9.7	1,740,168	3.12
Mexican grocery stores	76.7	49.6	79.8	39.4	91.2	4.3	8.1	11.1	16.6	2,974,073	5.33
Agriculture	88.3	16.4	91.2	44.3	88.9	10.0	11.0	2.9	14.5	5,823,845	10.44
Domestic employees	96.7	12.5	98.6	49.2	93.5	6.8	6.7	2.2	0.0	2,421,327	4.34
Fishing	84.9	23.3	89.2	50.8	77.1	9.2	22.3	2.1	3.3	161,219	0.29
Animal breeding & exploitation	80.3	30.9	77.0	17.2	94.1	8.3	6.5	4.0	11.6	818,301	1.47
Informal construction	85.8	36.6	83.8	11.7	90.2	5.6	11.2	0.8	0.3	3,599,306	6.45
Restaurant/Bar: Food/drinks	73.4	29.9	67.0	35.3	92.6	5.0	7.8	2.8	8.6	3,491,055	6.26
Repair/maintain: Cars/trucks	71.2	43.9	80.5	14.9	87.9	3.4	11.9	3.2	2.1	996,729	1.79
Haircuts/Grooming/Makeup	78.8	20.1	82.5	27.4	82.4	5.1	16.0	3.0	0.7	539,148	0.97
Transportation: Air/Water/Railway	57.8	56.9	51.0	41.1	94.5	3.7	6.2	2.4	0.3	2,509,717	4.5
Retail: Stationery & other items	66.0	35.4	60.4	19.8	88.8	3.3	10.3	6.7	10.6	636,664	1.14
Retail: Clothing/footwear/etc	68.3	34.4	59.1	18.0	89.5	2.9	9.5	5.0	7.4	920,124	1.65
Wood industry	69.7	32.5	66.0	5.7	91.0	7.8	8.4	2.8	8.2	144,593	0.26
Other activities	68.1	21.8	50.9	20.7	92.0	6.1	8.3	2.1	4.6	1,237,516	2.22
Retail: Computers or household items	65.2	28.2	46.2	23.7	91.0	3.8	9.2	2.0	6.5	661,448	1.19
Food industry	56.2	29.3	46.5	24.6	94.6	5.4	7.1	2.8	8.9	2,098,743	3.76
Associations/Organizations	67.2	23.1	58.5	8.0	97.1	9.9	3.8	1.9	3.0	233,289	0.42
Furniture, mattresses, and blinds	64.5	32.6	54.5	4.4	91.5	5.8	8.6	1.7	2.6	460,521	0.83
Culture, sports, leisure	65.3	15.8	56.1	19.4	88.4	8.6	10.0	1.0	1.4	481,566	0.86
Aquaculture	47.4	42.3	64.7	0.9	87.8	1.1	10.0	2.4	5.0	20,613	0.04
Leather goods manufacturing	48.1	48.3	54.8	1.6	89.3	1.4	10.0	1.1	2.9	304,626	0.55
Textile products, except clothing	81.6	16.3	43.6	2.2	90.2	5.7	8.3	4.5	4.9	272,220	0.49
Repair/maintain: Machines/appliances	64.8	24.1	44.0	12.5	81.8	6.2	17.1	1.3	2.4	651,601	1.17
Clothing manufacturing	61.2	27.5	47.4	3.8	92.4	4.2	7.0	2.9	3.0	713,414	1.28
Retail: Hardware & glassware	45.3	43.9	45.3	5.8	94.6	2.1	5.0	2.4	4.8	433,846	0.78
Non-metal mineral-based products	48.1	33.1	41.3	6.2	92.6	4.1	7.4	1.6	2.5	349,025	0.63
Metal products	46.4	32.2	39.9	3.7	90.3	5.1	10.9	0.8	1.9	700,658	1.26
Internet & catalog-based retail	94.1	3.5	25.6	2.1	79.7	6.2	17.9	0.2	0.9	551,198	0.99
Printing and related industries	44.2	26.5	47.4	4.2	94.7	2.6	6.0	0.6	3.6	164,761	0.3
Real estate	45.9	21.5	42.3	12.2	92.7	5.4	7.1	0.6	1.8	331,989	0.59
Beverage and tobacco industry	34.4	38.6	32.0	9.8	97.1	4.9	4.5	3.6	3.3	274,305	0.49
Formal construction	32.8	42.5	32.9	4.0	93.9	5.4	6.9	0.6	0.6	632,296	1.13
Retail: Health care products	39.9	27.8	35.2	4.3	94.6	3.0	6.6	2.1	4.5	389,510	0.7
Wholesale trade	29.8	41.3	29.0	6.3	96.4	4.1	4.0	1.1	1.1	1,524,190	2.73
Business support	32.7	34.9	18.4	11.6	94.7	3.8	7.1	2.4	1.1	1,497,958	2.68
Retail: Vehicles/autoparts/fuel	26.1	38.6	22.5	4.5	95.6	3.7	4.9	1.8	1.3	656,162	1.18
Technical/Professional/Scientific	32.4	17.7	28.4	3.5	93.2	4.1	8.3	0.1	1.0	1,442,714	2.59
Mining	17.2	42.7	13.4	1.3	98.4	4.5	2.0	0.5	0.5	181,270	0.32
Textile Inputs	35.7	15.5	7.7	7.3	95.7	7.6	3.8	1.7	3.7	144,766	0.26
Paper industry	26.9	26.4	13.9	3.0	93.8	3.6	4.7	1.0	2.7	220,112	0.39
Convenience and department stores	12.2	30.0	11.3	8.8	99.3	2.5	2.4	1.6	0.6	993,486	1.78
Health and social assistance	24.8	10.9	14.9	3.9	95.4	5.7	5.6	0.5	2.3	1,648,510	2.95
Media services	13.6	27.1	10.9	1.0	98.7	5.3	3.3	1.1	0.5	399,741	0.72
Finance and insurance	15.1	28.3	8.8	0.5	99.2	3.0	3.2	0.4	0.0	574,165	1.03
Government	18.7	23.0	6.4	0.5	99.2	6.5	1.8	0.4	0.8	2,387,417	4.28
Temporary accommodation: Hotels	12.6	24.7	11.7	2.8	97.8	2.8	2.9	0.6	0.2	444,692	0.8
Education services	17.2	4.7	7.1	0.9	98.4	10.4	3.0	0.2	1.1	2,684,125	4.81
Supply of electricity, water or gas	10.1	19.1	6.4	0.1	98.4	6.2	1.7	0.7	0.4	200,342	0.36
Formal manufacturing	4.0	23.2	4.4	1.4	98.6	2.1	2.5	0.7	0.3	3,002,453	5.38
Corporate services	3.9	20.4	3.9	0.1	99.3	2.4	3.2	0.2	0.0	59,563	0.11

Notes:

The statistics show the proportion of workers in each economic activity who are experiencing a specific dimension of labour precarity, relative to the total number of people working in that activity.

Table 1.8 – Informal employment rates in Mexico by gender (2019 and 2024)

Year	Quarter	Informal employment rate (Men)	Informal employment rate (Women)	Informal employment rate (Total)
2019	Q1	56.2	57.6	56.7
	Q2	55.5	57.2	56.2
	Q3	55.6	57.5	56.4
	Q4	55.1	57.5	56.1
2024	Q1	53.5	55.6	54.3
	Q2	53.8	54.9	54.3
	Q3	54.1	55.4	54.6
	Q4	54.0	55.2	54.5

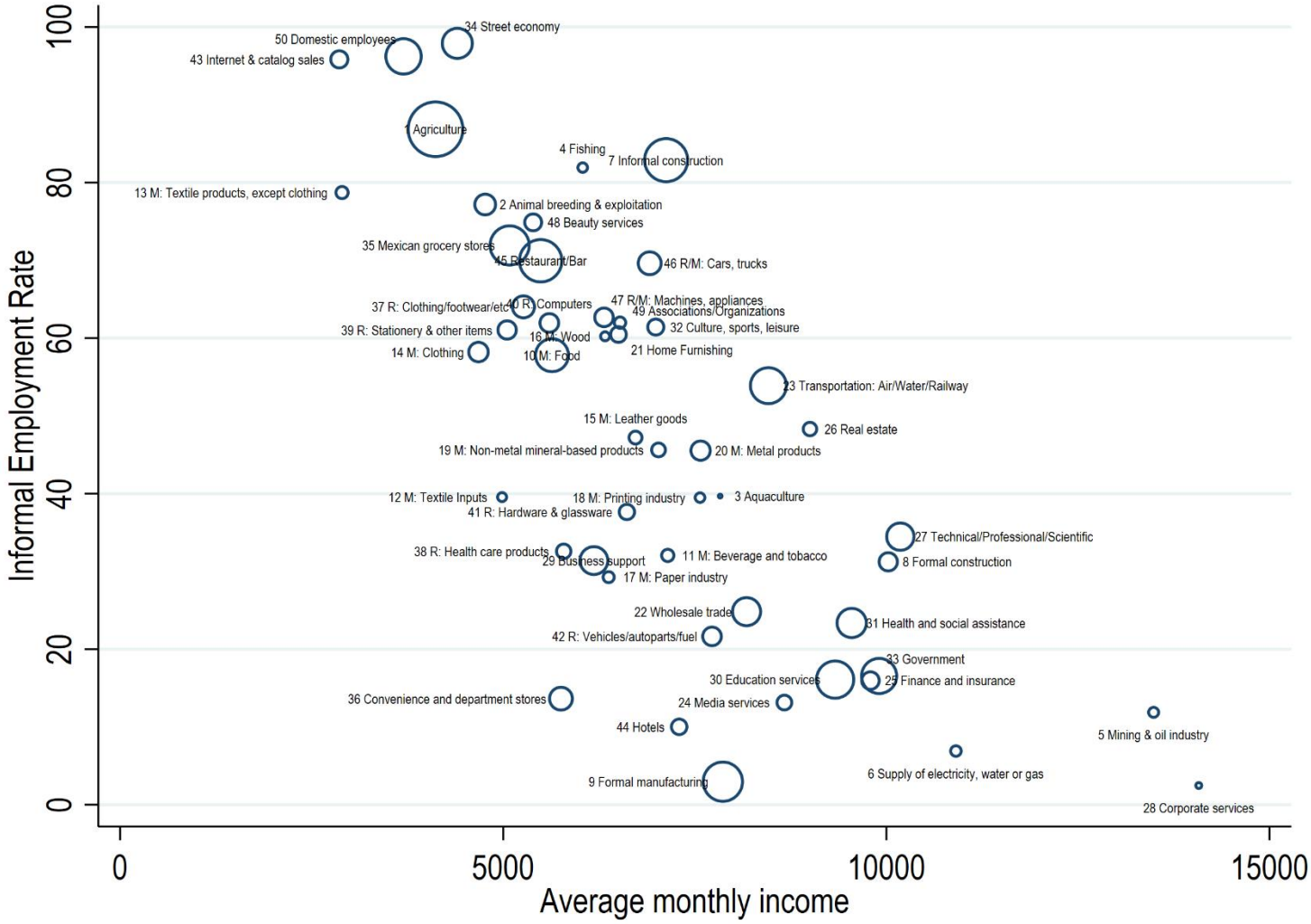
Source: INEGI statistics from the ENOE household survey

Table 1.9 – Gender composition of the informal and the formal workforce in Mexico (2019)

Labour status	Labour force in absolute terms	Share of men	Share of women	Male workforce in absolute terms	Female workforce in absolute terms
Formal workforce	24,305,506	61.72%	38.28%	15,001,358	9,304,148
Informal workforce	31,495,574	59.57%	40.43%	18,761,913	12,733,661

Source: INEGI statistics from the ENOE household survey

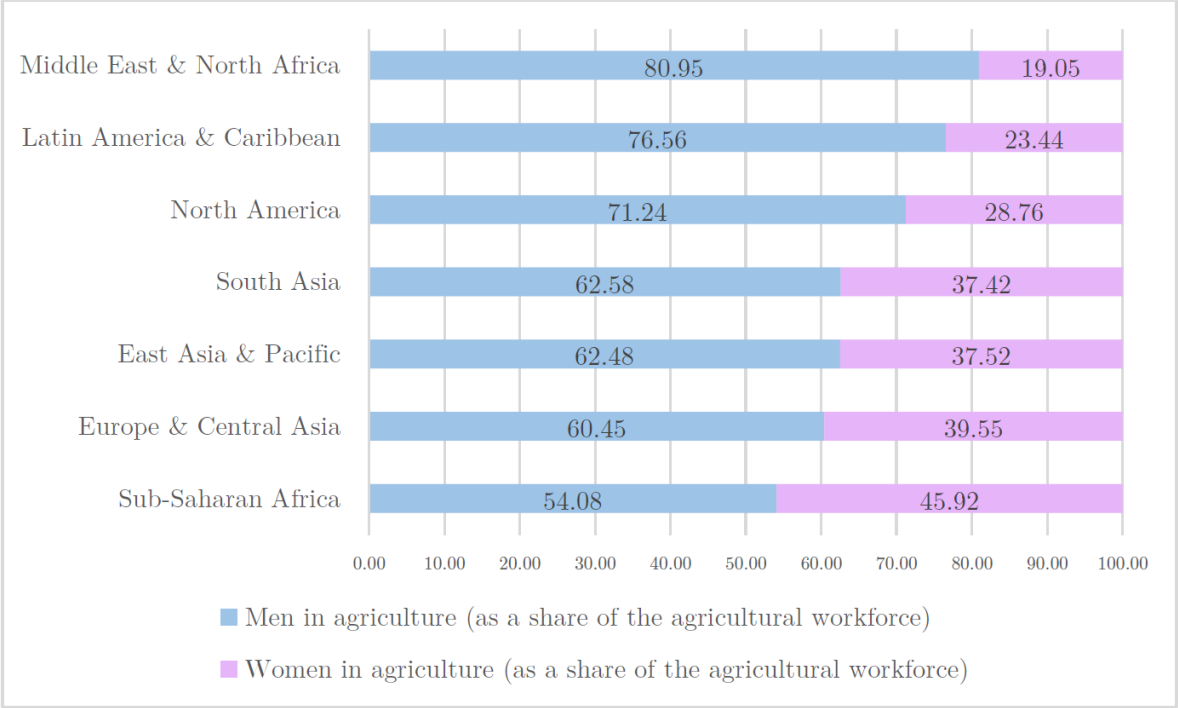
Figure 1.4 - Informal employment rates and average monthly labour incomes across 50 economic activities.



Notes:

- *The size of the dots reflects the proportion of people employed in each economic activity.*
- *These 50 economic activities account for 98% of the total labour force in Mexico.*
- *Economic activities starting with 'M:' are manufacturing activities.*
- *Economic activities starting with 'R:' are retail services.*
- *The estimates of informal employment rates and the share of women and men in each economic activity fall within the variation coefficients established by INEGI, based on the sampling design of the ENOE household survey, as shown in Table .*
- *A detailed explanation of how each of the 50 economic activities was categorised can be found in Table .*

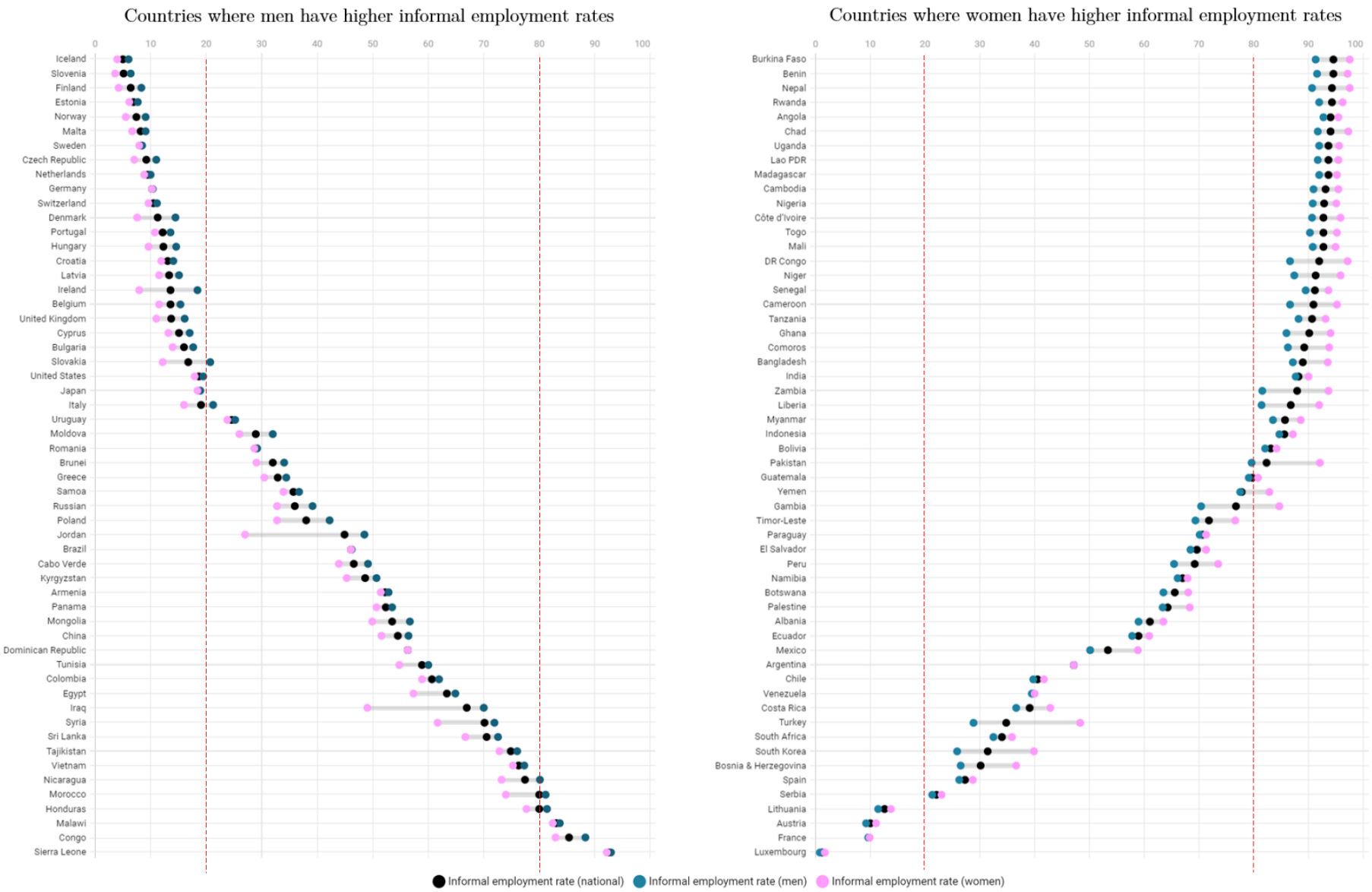
Figure 1.5 – Composition of the agricultural workforce by sex and region (2022)



Notes:

- *Made by the author using data from the World Bank.*
- *The figure illustrates that men represent the predominant share of the agricultural workforce in all regions of the world, based on the classification of areas established by the World Bank.*
- *This is in line with Doss & Gottlieb (2025)who find that, in their sample of 85 countries, men represent more than half of those employed in agriculture in the majority of countries.*

Figure 1.6 – The reversal of gender gaps in informal employment rates across countries



Notes:

- *This figure covers 112 countries, with estimates of informal employment rates that include, for the first time, agriculture alongside industry and services.*
- *The left-hand side of the figure shows that in 56 countries, ranging from Iceland to Sierra Leone, men report higher informal employment rates than women.*
- *The right-hand side of the figure shows that in 56 countries, from Burkina Faso to Luxembourg, women exhibit higher informal employment rates than men.*
- *The figure suggests that, once agriculture is considered, women do not exhibit higher informal employment rates across countries.*
- *ILO (2018) reports that the estimates were obtained after harmonising household surveys conducted by each country, using data from different years (mostly 2010–2016).*
- *ILO (2018) indicates that its estimates of informal employment rates cover 119 countries. They also note that the statistics for seven countries were obtained from ILOSTAT, but the estimates of informal employment rates for these seven countries do not appear in their Appendix. Hence, this analysis relies on the estimates for 112 countries.*
- *Another interesting trend in this figure is that most countries with low informal employment rates (20% or less) tend to exhibit higher informal employment rates for men. In contrast, countries with high informal employment rates (80% or more) consistently report higher informal employment rates for women.*
- *The figure suggests a reversal of gender gaps in informal employment as part of economic development.*
- *In low-income countries with high informality rates, formal jobs may be reserved for or taken by men, which may explain why women report higher informal employment rates.*
- *In high-income countries with low informality rates, most women secure formal jobs, while some may prefer not to work rather than take informal jobs. Most men also obtain formal jobs, but those who do not may be more inclined to take informal jobs. This may explain why men report higher informality rates than women in developed countries.*
- *The World Bank (2022) find a similar pattern. In low-income countries, women are more likely to take the most vulnerable jobs (self-employment and unpaid work in family businesses). Meanwhile, the gender gap flips in high-income countries, as men tend to occupy the most vulnerable jobs in developed economies.*
- *The interpretations drawn from this figure are illustrative. Other explanations of the phenomenon identified in this research may also be valid. It is beyond the scope of this study to identify the mechanisms driving this cross-country pattern.*